Adam Holdsfire

Gunsmith

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

The masquerade was the talk of Manchester, right up until the music stopped. The orchestra slipped in by the river door. Four masked guests slipped up to the private landing. By midnight the papers were screaming massacre, and nobody could find a body, a name, or a coroner willing to sign for one. The proprietress, Miss Cassie Castello, had vanished with the last dance.

TONIGHT

The black envelopes came to your door, signed by nobody you would dare name. You came anyway. Curious. A little reckless. Wear it well. Before the night is through, someone will be found dead, and the rest of you will have opinions.

FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Builds the finest revolvers in the county and has never fired one. A good gun, like a good argument, is best left in the holster.

BACKGROUND

You sell guns, locks and nails. You keep a register of every poison and every cartridge you have ever sold, and you have a very long memory for who bought what.

- Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff whose revolver you built and who has never loaded it.
- Joshua Kamin-Sky: reads the soot in your chimney; taught you a Yiddish word you are proud of.
- Arjun Bat: bought his bat from your hardware counter.

WHAT TO WEAR A gunsmith's leather apron over a good shirt, a monocle, and a half-mask with a brass finish.

THE BLACK VEIL

Adam Holdsfire · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You sold six boxes of blanks to a lady's agent for cash and never asked why.

YOURS TO SHARE You picked up one Yiddish word from Josh, “shmendrik,” and use it more than you should.

WHAT YOU KNOW

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY That October you sold six boxes of blank cartridges to a lady's agent, cash, no name. Blanks. Never a ball.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY A stranger bought a short-barrel revolver from you, billed to “K. Kessler, c/o Fitch & Fitch, Boston.” You remember because nobody ever questioned the invoice.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR In 1921 you sold the Veil a vault lock with three keyways and a dial. The combination was set in your shop by one person, a lady, alone.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Your poison register shows the House bought four ounces of nux vomica tincture in September, “for river rats,” signed R. Chow.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY An old man came to your shop in 1925 and asked whether a safe could be drilled if the dial's combination were lost. You said no, not without the lady who set it.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Rhea Mallya of Mallya's Emporium: You sold the House its last bottle of nux vomica and rang it up as “river rats” without asking how many.

You start with **$1,000** *in House bills (10 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the Veil candle. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A brass candlestick burns beside her portrait, and a ring of salt keeps it company.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **Who were you?**

You have worn this cover for a year. Learn what you really were before you took this name: some guests have noticed what a cover cannot hide.

Type: *What was your real trade?* **1 POINT**

Objectives 3 to 5 are in your black envelope

If you are one of the five, your private page already knows. Everyone else's has the same sealed flap with nothing behind it.

Type your answers on your phone whenever you like. Only your last answer counts.

Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem

Night telegraph office

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

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LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Every wire in town crosses their desk after dark. News travels fast, and these two are first to read it.

BACKGROUND

Every wire that goes in or out of Manchester after dark passes through your hands. You decoded one in 1924 and were told to forget it. You wrote it down instead. Charlie, who works the key beside you, keeps the night shift company.

- Leon Gee: your friend at WFEA, who sends messages that look innocent and are not.
- J. Bruce Wayne: wires his tailor in London, and tips like a man who wants to be remembered.
- Erika Lamm: wanted; has bought a telegram form from you and does not say why.

WHAT TO WEAR A clerk's visor and sleeve garters, a telegraph pencil behind the ear, and a single green glove.

THE BLACK VEIL

Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You once filed a Montreal telegram, paid in advance, with no sender.

WHAT YOU KNOW

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR The telegram said to carry Cassie's orders was filed at Boston North Station in a clerk's block capitals, paid by a Boston account, on a day Cassie was last seen in Manchester.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY The five unsigned envelopes were handed in at your counter by a woman in a veil with a stiff left shoulder. She paid in advance, in gold, and said they were from someone who was 'quite well.'

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY In 1925 an old man dictated twenty-two names for you to wire to a Boston lawyer. You wired them and kept the carbon; you understood only when you saw the same hand at the top of the Roll of Placements.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to wire a piece of news to every paper in New England.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY On 7 October twenty-four envelopes crossed your counter: nineteen signed “The House,” paid for by a Boston account, and five unsigned, in a woman's hand, ending “The veil lifts.”

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY A telegraph slip once passed under your pencil: “Notary to sign forged orders under duress; if he refuses, he joins the List.”

YOURS TO SHARE Erika bought a telegram form from you and watched the door the whole time. A fugitive's habit, nothing more.

YOURS TO SHARE At the telegraph office she looks at the clock whenever the bell on the door rings, as if she had a message to deliver.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Diwakar Sandbagg: You were paid to take a fall on Halloween 1924 and told to stay down until the music stopped.

You start with **$1,000** *in House bills (10 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the vault cloche. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A glass dome over a marble stand hides what the House keeps under glass.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A fair trade**

Strike a bargain with Erika Lamm: your blank telegram form for their set of false papers. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag.

Type: *The code on the tag you received* **1 POINT**

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Angelos Bowles

Card sharp

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

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LAST CALL

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YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Deals fast, bets faster, and always has one more hand to play. The smile across the table is part of the game.

BACKGROUND

You read tells for a living: a twitch, a hesitation, a glass left untouched. You deal fast and bet faster, and you have sat across a table from every guest here at least once.

- Mihir Nagarkatti: your backer, and your best friend, in that order.
- Diwakar Sandbagg: the prizefighter whose hands you cannot stop watching.
- Silas Palmer: plays the room where you work the back table.

WHAT TO WEAR A bowler hat, a waistcoat full of loose coin, and a casino chip you roll across your knuckles.

THE BLACK VEIL

Angelos Bowles · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You know the Keeper touches his watch when he bluffs, and it has not run since 1924.

WHAT YOU KNOW

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Markers are the House's own currency. You have seen the Butler take one in place of cash for something that was on no menu.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Your black envelope held a card on stiff House stock, ruled and sealed, signed only “The House.” It was a Boston printer's work. Nothing about it was Cassie's.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Ignatius Bell, who held the second door at the Veil, owed you twenty dollars. He was shot in a Granite Street shed, and the big man who worked the other door was never found.

YOUR HABIT You roll a casino chip across your knuckles and count the pot with your thumb across your fingertips, a card sharp's habit. Do it whenever chips or money are on the table.

You start with **$1,200** *in House bills (12 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **Money to make**

Win a few hands, a few bets, a few boules. Leave with at least $1,800. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A thing to find**

Find the Veil candle. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A brass candlestick burns beside her portrait, and a ring of salt keeps it company.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

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Type your answers on your phone whenever you like. Only your last answer counts.

THE BLACK VEIL
Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor

Heir

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

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LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Mahns Manor has more rooms than guests and more portraits than friends. The fortune does most of the talking.

BACKGROUND

Your late father was the Black Veil's Silent Partner from the first night: the standing reservation upstairs, the drafts paid to a vault and never to a bank. He left you the Manor, its mortgage, and a brass key on a ribbon he called “the Silent Partner's tooth.”

- Silas Palmer: the bandleader whose band you quietly underwrite.
- Molly Daniel: rents your cellar for a still of her own, and pays you in gossip.
- J. Bruce Wayne: the playboy who holds your mortgage and has never once mentioned it.

WHAT TO WEAR A black velvet ribbon at the throat, gloves, and the airs of a woman who does not need to count.

THE BLACK VEIL

Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You wear your father's brass key on a ribbon under your collar and have never once tried it in a lock.

WHAT YOU KNOW

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD Your father told you once, drunk, that Mahns money paid everyone's shares on the night of "the Exit," and that the Veil was never meant to survive Halloween.

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You inherited your father's brass key on a ribbon. He called it "the Silent Partner's tooth" and would never say what it opens.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR "K.K." endorsed every Mahns draft for three years: an old man with a white beard and a watch he never reset.

YOURS TO SHARE Your father used to mock him: "Nine o'clock, honey in the rye, as if the clock needed him."

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD In 1925 he asked you in writing, three times, for your father's brass key. You never answered.

YOURS TO SHARE At your table he fingers the air like a bank teller counting whenever a bill is mentioned, before the number is finished.

YOURS TO SHARE At every party she straightens somebody's hat brim, hers, yours, a stranger's, without noticing she has done it.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY The seamstresses who made the gowns and masks for the Veil's last masquerade were dead within the year, one at a time, and the dressmaker who ran them was never found.

You start with **$3,000** *in House bills (30 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **Money to make**

A fortune is kept by spending it wisely. Make the room pay you back. Leave with at least $3,600. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A thing to find**

Find the sugar dish. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A glass dish with a lid sits where the sweets go. The tag is under the lid.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

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THE BLACK VEIL

Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Anthony Hung, Esq.

Defense attorney

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Has never lost a case, only a jury. Charges by the word, and every word is worth it.

BACKGROUND

You practise from a second-floor office above a dentist and read every contract twice. You have drawn papers for half the people in this room and remember what each of them tried to hide.

- Rhea Mallya: the Emporium's counsel is you; you read her leases and are not telling anyone what is in them.
- Eric Leeway: the judge who dismisses your cases and has never read your briefs.
- Tim McGinley: a client you have defended three times and billed once.

WHAT TO WEAR A lawyer's three-piece suit, a flourish of a signature on every page, and a mask with an air of reasonable doubt.

THE BLACK VEIL

Anthony Hung, Esq. · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You drew name-change papers for a dozen strangers, paid in gold by “a friend,” and kept the carbon.

WHAT YOU KNOW

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Late in October 1924 you drew name-change papers for a dozen strangers, “in case of a fire,” said the client. They never came back for copies.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR In 1925 the court showed you three “orders in Cassie's hand.” You noticed the i's were dotted with tiny rings and the signature was too neat to be hers.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Fitch & Fitch of Boston, who sent you “K. Kessler's” instructions, had one client of that name: the old keeper of a supper club.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY You drew Nag Oil's incorporation in 1925: capital paid in by one stranger, in gold, and a signature in a clerk's neat hand.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY You drew the advance papers in 1924. The Teller's share sat in an account stubbed “Crane, advance,” and later you saw the same stub on the hitman's bills.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY He corrected the statute number in a carnival licence you drafted, without being asked. A barker should not know that.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY The three forged orders carry the smudge of a notary's embossing seal, as if a notary had been made to sign them against his will.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Mihir Nagarkatti of Nag Oil: Your “gusher” was a burst water main, and you lost a bet to the Keeper over it.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Judge Eric Leeway: You let three “orders in C.C.'s hand” stand, though the clerk swore the i's had rings.

You start with **$1,200** *in House bills (12 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **Money to make**

Charge by the word. Sell advice, draw a paper, collect a retainer. Leave with at least $1,800. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A thing to find**

Find the Bill of Rights. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. The little book beside it, with the rights every defendant has.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

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THE BLACK VEIL

Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Arjun Bat

Slugger

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YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Has never met a pitch that didn't deserve a swing, or a fence that didn't deserve a dent. The ball usually gets the worst of it.

BACKGROUND

You grew up in a mill family and hauled bricks as a boy. You were offered $500 to strike out in the 1925 mill championship and never quite decided whether the money was taken.

- Joshua Kamin-Sky: a boyhood friend and the only person who laughs at your jokes.
- Mihir Nagarkatti: the oilman whose offer you took, or did not.
- Adam Holdsfire: sold you your first glove and has opinions about your swing.

WHAT TO WEAR A Textiles team jersey, a cap, and a bat you insist is for sentimental reasons.

THE BLACK VEIL

Arjun Bat · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You hauled bricks in 1921 for a wall in the Merrimack Room that is too thick.

WHAT YOU KNOW

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR As a boy you hauled bricks for a wall in the Merrimack Room in 1921, double-thick behind the window. Nobody told you why.

YOURS TO SHARE Angelos counts the pot with his thumb across his fingertips the way every card sharp does. He did it when you were both at Rockingham Park in 1919.

YOURS TO SHARE The barker signed your ticket with a ring over every i and tapped his pen twice, like a notary sealing a deed.

YOURS TO SHARE The bandleader has tipped his hat to you across the dugout rail for three seasons. It is a stage habit.

YOURS TO SHARE His knuckles are split-scarred the way a bouncer's get, not powder-burned the way a gunsmith's do. You have seen enough scarred hands in the clubhouse to know.

YOURS TO SHARE At the ballpark Erika sits in the top row facing the gate. A fugitive's habit, nothing more.

YOURS TO SHARE The newsie glances at the nearest clock every time a door opens, even in the dugout where nothing is ever late.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Silas Palmer of the Palm Court: You have sung the same scat phrase at every club since 1921, and it was Cassie's own call.

You start with **$800** *in House bills (8 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 Money to make

Win a wager on a swing, a pitch or a bet. Leave with at least $1,400. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end*

1 POINT

OBJECTIVE 2 A thing to find

Find the Kraken Cove candle stand. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. Eight arms hold up a single candle, in the cabinet with the good glass.

Type: *The code on the tag*

1 POINT

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THE BLACK VEIL

Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Diwakar Sandbagg

Prizefighter

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

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YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Takes a punch the way other people take a compliment: calmly, with a plan, and for a fee.

BACKGROUND

You fight the river-town circuit and nobody has ever seen you in the Manchester ring. You are a man who loses in the third round exactly when the odds say you should.

- Mihir Nagarkatti: the oilman who stakes your fights, and does not ask why.
- Angelos Bowles: studies you at every table.
- Arjun Bat: a fellow sportsman who trades stories and bruises.

WHAT TO WEAR A boxer's robe over a dinner jacket, taped knuckles, and a mask that is not meant to hide a broken nose.

THE BLACK VEIL

Diwakar Sandbagg · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You were paid to take a fall on Halloween 1924 and told to stay down until the music stopped.

WHAT YOU KNOW

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR On Halloween night 1924 you took a paid fall in a river-town ring and were told to stay down until the music stopped. By morning the whole river knew the Veil's “massacre” was stage blood, and that no coroner had been called.

YOURS TO SHARE The oilman counts invisible bills with his thumb across his fingertips whenever a purse is mentioned, even when his hands are empty. You have watched him do it across the ring.

YOURS TO SHARE On the fight poster the barker lettered, every i wears a tiny ring. He tapped his pen twice when he signed the purse.

YOURS TO SHARE You asked her for a short cut to the ring, and she named the back stair behind the Farrago's pressroom that runs straight down to the river road. That is a runner's knowledge, not a newsie's.

YOURS TO SHARE The barnstormer glances at his wristwatch at every knock. He told you a flier is always late for something.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Luke Shelldon: You built stage blood for a “private masquerade” billed to a post-office box.

You start with **$1,000** *in House bills (10 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **Money to make**

Win a purse: a bet, an arm-wrestle, a wager. Leave with at least $1,600. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A thing to find**

Find the champion's weight. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A prize weight that nobody is lifting. Look where a heavy thing sits quietly.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

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Dr. Emmerich Sunner

Doctor

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

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LAST CALL

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YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Steady hands, a black bag, and a bedside manner that talks patients out of a fuss. Will see you sooner or later.

BACKGROUND

You have been the county physician for four years and the Sheriff's examiner for three. You have seen what a stage looks like and what a body looks like, and you can tell the two apart.

- Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff, who asks you what killed them and rarely likes the answer.
- Rhea Mallya: the Emporium's druggist fills your prescriptions.
- Silas Palmer: the bandleader whose throat you treat.

WHAT TO WEAR A doctor's bag, a stethoscope, a white coat over a dinner jacket, and a small black mask.

THE BLACK VEIL

Dr. Emmerich Sunner · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You ate beet sandwiches for a week to prove the “blood” was beets and sugar.

WHAT YOU KNOW

YOURS TO SHARE That night you were called to a fainting guest, not a wound: the “blood” on the glove smelled of beet and sugar. No coroner was ever summoned and you signed no certificate.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR You reviewed several of those “accidents” and noticed the same thing in each: a small number sewn inside the coat lining, running from 1 to 17 and never beyond.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY As the county physician you are the only one who may examine the body. The signs you will find point to strychnine in sweetened rye.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY The numbers sewn into the coat linings ran 1 to 17. Never 18 to 22.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to certify a death. It did not say whose.

YOURS TO SHARE His hands carry no oil. There are clerk's calluses on the right thumb, the kind you earn counting coin for a living.

YOURS TO SHARE Her left forefinger carries a seamstress's pin-pricks. A shopkeeper's hands do not look like that.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY You certified Olive Brandt, a seamstress, in February 1925 after a carriage ran her down. The pins in her hem were the Veil's masks. Every girl in her room died within the year.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Krrish Vermouth: You delivered a crate of wine in November 1924 on a draft signed K. Kessler to a grey Hudson that later turned up in the river.

YOUR HABIT You dot every i with a tiny ring when you write, as you were taught writing prescriptions. Do it on anything you sign or note.

You start with **$1,000** *in House bills (10 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 A thing to find

Find the decoy duck. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A decoy that is hollow inside sits in the cabinet. Lift its head.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 What Luke Shelldon is hiding

Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Luke Shelldon's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it.

Type: *The key word or name* **1 POINT**

Objectives 3 to 5 are in your black envelope

If you are one of the five, your private page already knows. Everyone else's has the same sealed flap with nothing behind it.

Type your answers on your phone whenever you like. Only your last answer counts.

THE BLACK VEIL

Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Erika Lamm

Fugitive

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

The masquerade was the talk of Manchester, right up until the music stopped. The orchestra slipped in by the river door. Four masked guests slipped up to the private landing. By midnight the papers were screaming massacre, and nobody could find a body, a name, or a coroner willing to sign for one. The proprietress, Miss Cassie Castello, had vanished with the last dance.

TONIGHT

The black envelopes came to your door, signed by nobody you would dare name. You came anyway. Curious. A little reckless. Wear it well. Before the night is through, someone will be found dead, and the rest of you will have opinions.

FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Never far from a door, and never in one town for long. Always seems to be leaving, even when arriving.

BACKGROUND

You bought a false name from a masked man at the river steps on 31 October 1924 and you have been using a different one every season since. You hid at Rebecca's boarding house more than once.

- Rebecca Chow: has hidden you, for money, and will again.
- Ananya Codru: sold you a blank telegram form without asking why.
- Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff who wants you, and has never recognised you in a hat.

WHAT TO WEAR A travelling coat with the collar up, a hat pulled low, and a false moustache you may or may not wear.

THE BLACK VEIL

Erika Lamm · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You bought a name at the river steps for $20 and were told at least twenty others did too.

WHAT YOU KNOW

YOURS TO SHARE That night you bought a false name from a masked man at the river steps, $20 and no questions. So did half the river. “The Exit,” he called it.

YOURS TO SHARE He looked at your false papers for one second and named the stationer who printed them. Forgers know forgers.

YOURS TO SHARE The gunsmith never sits with his back to a door and always counts the exits. You recognise it because you do it too.

YOURS TO SHARE You have watched the Sheriff check every exit in every room for a year. It's habit, not guilt.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR You hid on the river road that winter and watched the Veil's runners go one by one; the last was thrown off the steps, and the girl who ran with him ran.

YOUR HABIT You check the exits wherever you go and sit where you can see the door. A fugitive's habit.

You start with **$600** *in House bills (6 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **Money to make**

Earn a little without being noticed. Leave with at least $1,200. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end*

1 POINT

OBJECTIVE 2 **A thing to find**

Find the masquerade mask. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A carved face from the night of the masquerade watches the room from the shelves.

Type: *The code on the tag*

1 POINT

Objectives 3 to 5 are in your black envelope

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J. Bruce Wayne

Wealthy playboy

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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TONIGHT

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Always in the society pages, never at the office. Nobody can say what J. Bruce does, only where.

BACKGROUND

J. Bruce Wayne is in every society column and in no office. You bought the Mahns mortgage the week you arrived in Manchester in 1925, and nobody has asked why.

- Anika Mahns: your mortgage, and your reason to be seen at her parties.
- Mihir Nagarkatti: the oilman whose money is louder than yours, and older.
- Krrish Vermouth: delivers your vermouth and has never once been paid on time.

WHAT TO WEAR Dinner jacket, a cigar you never light, and a black mask that does not quite cover your eyes.

THE BLACK VEIL

J. Bruce Wayne · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD Your “office” is the back room of a hat shop, and the Keeper once used its telephone to call Boston.

WHAT YOU KNOW

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR In 1925 an old man wrote a list of twenty-two names on the counter of your hat shop and crossed them off one by one as the months went by.

YOURS TO SHARE At the club he rubs thumb across fingers whenever anyone says “purse” or “stake,” the way a teller counts.

YOURS TO SHARE Dr. Sunner has written your headache powders with ringed i's since 1925. It is a pharmacy habit, nothing more.

YOURS TO SHARE She turned your hat a quarter inch in the cloakroom and did not say sorry.

YOURS TO SHARE Silas tips his hat to everyone and sets the brim straight afterward. You have seen it at every club since 1921: a bandleader's courtesy.

YOURS TO SHARE He knew every name in the room after one introduction, like a man trained to remember who he lets through a door. You introduced him to forty people last night.

You start with **$3,000** *in House bills (30 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **Money to make**

Let the room pay for your charm: win a hand, sell a story, collect a favour in cash. Leave with at least $3,600. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A thing to find**

Find the red bird. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A small red bird perches somewhere it should not, away from its lamp.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

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Joshua Kamin-Sky

Soothsayer

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

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LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Reads fortunes in palms, clouds and the bottom of a teacup, and is right more often than is comfortable.

BACKGROUND

You read palms, clouds and the bottom of a teacup, and now and then the soot in a chimney. Your family came from Poland to work the mills, and a star-marked box of salt is on your mother's shelf. A soothsayer notices what people burn.

- Tiffany Liu: your partner in windows and roofs; you read the glass, she makes it.
- Arjun Bat: a fellow mill family; you have known him since you were both small.
- Adam Holdsfire: you read the soot in his shop's chimney and he reads your debts.

WHAT TO WEAR A shawl of rich colours, a turban, a crystal you do not believe in, and a six-pointed star pinned to your lapel. It is a Friday night, so you feel the Sabbath keenly.

THE BLACK VEIL

Joshua Kamin-Sky · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You read tea leaves off half-burned pages you swept from an empty flue.

YOURS TO SHARE If anyone asks you for a Yiddish word to shout at an umpire, give them “shmendrik.” It means a fool, and it is the funniest word you know.

WHAT YOU KNOW

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY In the flue of an empty room above the river you read the soot off half-burned pages: “C. is out. K. holds the books. Place them as I wrote.” You still have a torn register page.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR The flue of the Merrimack Room runs behind a brick wall that is too thick on the inside. A safe lives there.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR The burned sign-out slips from the flue all carried marker numbers. The unburned five, 18 to 22, were never signed back.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY In 1925 an old man hired you to read the soot in the Merrimack Room flue and asked, more than once, how thick the wall was behind the window.

YOURS TO SHARE You read his palm once: a gambler's lines and a gambler's habit. He has counted that way his whole life.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY You read a half-burned notary's seal out of the flue, ringed with the letters E.L., together with scraps of forged orders signed in Cassie's name.

YOURS TO SHARE You have the photographs: Silas tips his hat at every greeting, in every photograph, since the band began.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Molly Daniel of the Manchester Union: You kept the unprinted line the city desk cut: no coroner, no ambulance.

You start with **$800** *in House bills (8 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the star-marked salt. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A blue box with a six-pointed star, in the pantry where the salt is kept.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A fair trade**

Strike a bargain with Tiffany Liu of the Lamps: your soothsayer's charm for their glass earring. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag.

Type: *The code on the tag you received* **1 POINT**

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Judge Eric Leeway

Judge

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

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LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Light sentences, long lunches, and a gavel that rarely gets raised. Everyone leaves this courtroom smiling.

BACKGROUND

You came to the bench in 1925 with excellent references and no previous court record anywhere. Your gavel falls like a metronome and the docket moves faster than any in the state.

- Anthony Hung: argues before you and has never won an acquittal.
- Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff, who watches your bench more closely than he admits.
- Krrish Vermouth: sends the bench a crate of wine every Friday, and you never ask why.

WHAT TO WEAR Judge's black robes, a powdered wig if you can find one, and a small half-mask.

THE BLACK VEIL

Judge Eric Leeway · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You let three “orders in C.C.'s hand” stand, though the clerk swore the i's had rings.

WHAT YOU KNOW

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY In 1925 a list of twenty-two names, in Kit Kessler's hand, crossed out one by one, came across your bench in a case that was never tried.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to sign a charter. It did not say whose.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY In 1925 an old man asked you, as a hypothetical, how long a person must be missing before a court will declare her dead.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Nag Oil's drilling leases carry no drilling permits, and every payment was counted out in gold by a man who counted like a banker.

YOURS TO SHARE In your corridor she checks the court clock every time a door opens, like a courier counting minutes.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Adam Holdsfire: You sold six boxes of blanks to a lady's agent for cash and never asked why.

You start with **$1,500** *in House bills (15 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 A thing to find

Find the Judge's board. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A board in a box on the black table, with one white piece missing from its rank.

Type: *The code on the tag*

1 POINT

OBJECTIVE 2 The Friday crate

Accept Krrish Vermouth's Friday crate of wine and quietly dismiss his cases. Keep his crate receipt and hand him a notice of dismissal: read the code on the receipt. Nobody is to know.

Type: *The code on the crate receipt*

1 POINT

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Krrish Vermouth

Wine importer

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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TONIGHT

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Fine wine and vermouth arrive in Manchester by the crate, no questions asked and none answered.

BACKGROUND

Fine wine and vermouth reach Manchester by the crate, and you are the reason, no questions asked and none answered. You keep your invoices in four languages and your customers in three social classes.

- Eric Leeway: a regular at your cellar door on Fridays, for reasons neither of you states.
- J. Bruce Wayne: buys your vermouth and pays in compliments.
- Anika Mahns: the Manor's cellar is the best customer you cannot say you have.

WHAT TO WEAR A wine merchant's grey frock coat, a corkscrew on a chain, and a half-mask the colour of burgundy.

THE BLACK VEIL

Krrish Vermouth · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You delivered a crate of wine in November 1924 on a draft signed K. Kessler to a grey Hudson that later turned up in the river.

WHAT YOU KNOW

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY In the first days of November 1924 you delivered an odd number of cases of wine to a West Side boarding house, and every guest who signed for them said the same nervous thing: they had been told to be dead for a season, and been paid for it.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR In November 1924 you delivered a crate of wine, billed to K. Kessler, to a grey Hudson waiting at the river steps. The driver never gave a name. The car turned up wrecked in the Merrimack that March.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY The draft that bought the hitman's grey Hudson was drawn on an account stubbed “Crane, advance.” The money was somebody's own share.

YOURS TO SHARE Dr. Sunner's prescription for the cough you catch in the cellar has ringed i's, like every physician's. It is the training, not a trick.

YOURS TO SHARE In your cellar she set a customer's hat straight on her way past and never broke step.

YOURS TO SHARE In your cellar he refused the armchair with its back to the door, and took a stool where he could see both entrances.

YOURS TO SHARE Sidd checks his watch whenever you deliver a crate, which you have always taken for a flier's nerves.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Joshua Kamin-Sky: You read tea leaves off half-burned pages you swept from an empty flue.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin: Two passengers went down the river steps that night; one came back alone with blood on his cuff.

You start with **$1,200** *in House bills (12 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the glowing bottle. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A bottle of wine that glows in the dark, though nobody lit it.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A fair trade**

Strike a bargain with Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor: your Silent Partner's brass key for their Mahns crested spoon. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag.

Type: *The code on the tag you received* **1 POINT**

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Leon Gee of WFEA

Radio announcer

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

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LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

The voice of WFEA, smooth enough to sell soap and loud enough to wake the dead. Half the town trusts every word; the other half just likes the sound.

BACKGROUND

You came from Canton by way of Boston. A certain lady sponsored your papers and your radio licence, and you owe her everything. You read the news at ten and the weather at eleven, and you are fond of both.

- Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff, who thinks you are insufferable on the air and is correct.
- Ananya Codru: your friend at the telegraph office; she keeps your secrets and you keep hers.
- Silas Palmer: the bandleader whose scat you recognise from somewhere you cannot place.

WHAT TO WEAR A microphone prop if you have one, a headset, a snappy suit, and a white carnation.

THE BLACK VEIL

Leon Gee of WFEA · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You once read the Sheriff's private mail aloud on the air by mistake, and he has never forgiven it.

WHAT YOU KNOW

YOURS TO SHARE Your 1 November 1924 bulletin said “massacre.” Off the record, the Sheriff's office told you that no coroner, ambulance or undertaker had been called, and not a body had been found.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Cassie trusted nobody with the books but the Keeper. You know the books changed hands the night she vanished, and that she called it a betrayal in a note you were never meant to keep.

YOURS TO SHARE Cassie signed with a plain “C.” and never a ring. She called anyone who dotted an i with a ring a show-off.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Cassie's own roll names the five who may still live: Ballard, Crane, Lyle, Marek and Pike. Markers 18 to 22 are theirs.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Cassie's roll lists twenty-two names and puts a star beside five. “Bring them,” she wrote.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to read a bulletin aloud, and the House would supply the text.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY “The veil lifts” is the closing phrase Cassie ended every note with, and it ended the five unsigned envelopes you saw on Ananya's counter. Nobody else writes it that way.

You start with **$1,000** *in House bills (10 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 A thing to find

Find the launch's fog horn. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. Something that once sounded a warning across the water now sits on the bookshelf.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 Out of the cell

Sheriff Farrago holds a citation against you, for being insufferable on the air. Pay a go-between at least $100 in House bills to broker a pardon. Tiffany Liu is the best choice. She hands you a go-between's receipt: read its code.

Type: *The code on the receipt* **1 POINT**

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THE BLACK VEIL

Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Luke Shelldon

Carnival barker

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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TONIGHT

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Hollers outside the tent until the whole street is inside it. Could sell you the show, the ticket and the change.

BACKGROUND

You have run the carnival's midway for six summers, and you hand-paint every handbill yourself. In October 1924 you built stage blood and breakaway furniture for a “private masquerade” and billed a post-office box. You never asked what it was for.

- Angelos Bowles: sits at the back table of every midway you have worked, and reads the marks.
- Silas Palmer: leads the band that plays your carnival, and cannot play a Charleston.
- Ananya Codru: sends your wires to the carnival's other towns and keeps your accounts straight.

WHAT TO WEAR A barker's straw boater, a striped coat, a cane, and a mask with a painted grin.

THE BLACK VEIL

Luke Shelldon · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You built stage blood for a “private masquerade” billed to a post-office box.

WHAT YOU KNOW

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR In October 1924 you built stage blood, trick bottles and a rack of breakaway furniture for a “private masquerade,” billed to a post-office box. Nobody told you the show would be called a massacre.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Angelos Bowles: You know the Keeper touches his watch when he bluffs, and it has not run since 1924.

You start with **$1,000** *in House bills (10 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the river lantern. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A grinning lantern keeps the dining table lit. Look where it glows.

Type: *The code on the tag*

1 POINT

OBJECTIVE 2 **Who were you?**

You have worn this cover for a year. Learn what you really were before you took this name: some guests have noticed what a cover cannot hide.

Type: *What was your real trade?*

1 POINT

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THE BLACK VEIL

Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Mihir Nagarkatti of Nag Oil

Oil master

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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TONIGHT

The black envelopes came to your door, signed by nobody you would dare name. You came anyway. Curious. A little reckless. Wear it well. Before the night is through, someone will be found dead, and the rest of you will have opinions.

FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

One gusher made a fortune, and the whole town has heard the story twice. Wells run dry; the swagger never does.

BACKGROUND

Nag Oil struck one gusher in 1923 and the whole town has heard the story twice. The wells have run dry since, and you have kept that quiet.

- Angelos Bowles: the card sharp who owes you for a night you both remember differently.
- Diwakar Sandbagg: the prizefighter whose purses you stake, and are curious about.
- Eric Leeway: the judge who rules on your drilling leases, and on little else you do.

WHAT TO WEAR An oilman's cream suit with a derrick-shaped tie pin, a pocket full of bills in a tidy roll, and a black half-mask.

THE BLACK VEIL

Mihir Nagarkatti of Nag Oil · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD Your “gusher” was a burst water main, and you lost a bet to the Keeper over it.

WHAT YOU KNOW

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR You once lost a bet with him. His terms: “I will be drinking my rye at nine o'clock, with honey in it, wherever I am.”

YOURS TO SHARE A Veil marker was a number and a promise. The old members carried them, and the House honoured one, once, from its owner only.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Sidd Airwind: You trained a mechanic who was later paid to be careless once.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Tiffany Liu of the Lamps: You cut the brass plate “KEEPER · K.K.” and your chisel slipped on the second K.

You start with **$3,000** *in House bills (30 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the Silent Partner's elephant. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A gilded elephant, who never forgets, leans on a book by the old globe.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **Who were you?**

You have worn this cover for a year. Learn what you really were before you took this name: some guests have noticed what a cover cannot hide.

Type: *What was your real trade?* **1 POINT**

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Molly Daniel of the Manchester Union

Newsie

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Hollers the headlines from the corner before the ink is dry. If it's news, Molly has it, and so does everyone within three blocks.

BACKGROUND

You have sold the Farrago on the corner of Elm and Hanover since 1919, and your papers reach every door in this room. A still in the Mahns Manor cellar pays for the dress you are wearing.

- Anika Mahns: your landlady in the cellar, and your best customer.
- Leon Gee: your headlines run on his radio the next morning, without credit.
- Eric Leeway: pays you to keep his name off the court column.

WHAT TO WEAR A newsboy cap, a satchel of papers, and a bundle of the Extra to sell at the right moment.

THE BLACK VEIL

Molly Daniel of the Manchester Union · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You kept the unprinted line the city desk cut: no coroner, no ambulance.

WHAT YOU KNOW

YOURS TO SHARE The Farrago ran “massacre” on 1 November 1924 and, in your hearing, the city desk admitted that not one coroner, ambulance or undertaker had been called.

YOURS TO SHARE The Farrago's 1924 society column called it “the Keeper's nine-o'clock rye with honey.”

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY A Boston courier left a ledger page with you in 1925 headed “Roll of Placements”: twenty-two names, seventeen crossed out in a clerk's hand. You kept it and told no one.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Selling the Farrago outside the cemetery gate in 1925, you counted the new graves of the Veil's people: seventeen. A clerk's note you found said “twenty-two to be placed.”

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Sheriff Theodor Farrago: You keep a shoebox with seventeen “accidents” in it and have told no one.

You start with **$900** *in House bills (9 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the masquerade mask. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A carved face from the night of the masquerade watches the room from the shelves.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **Who were you?**

You have worn this cover for a year. Learn what you really were before you took this name: some guests have noticed what a cover cannot hide.

Type: *What was your real trade?* **1 POINT**

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Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil

Butler

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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TONIGHT

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

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LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Runs the house, pours the drinks, keeps the secrets. Hears everything, repeats nothing, and holds the keys to every room.

BACKGROUND

You run the House: the bar, the locks, the tin box that holds the night's takings. You also keep a boarding house on the West Side, which is where a certain lady hid on the night of 31 October 1924 with a bandaged shoulder. Someone paid you $200 to forget her.

- Tim McGinley: supplies the House, and has seen what is under your bar.
- Leon Gee: you have a message of his you have never delivered.
- Erika Lamm: a boarder you hid at the House once, and would again, for the right fee.

WHAT TO WEAR A Butler's black coat with silver buttons, white gloves, a ring of keys, and an expression of discretion for hire.

THE BLACK VEIL

Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD The House whiskey is cold tea, and you took $200 to forget Room 3.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY You sell alibis at $100 each, and silence at more.

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD On 1 November 1924 you took $200 from “Mr. K.” to forget the lady in Room 3. You took it.

WHAT YOU KNOW

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD Your boarding-house register still has a page for Room 3 on 31 October 1924: a lady with a bandaged shoulder, and a margin note that “Mr. K.” paid you $200 to forget her.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR You keep the note Cassie left on your pillow in Room 3: “Thank you for the shoulder. — C.” She dots every i with a plain dot, never a ring.

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD Cassie hid in your boarding house on the night of 31 October with a bandaged shoulder. She lived, and left a note on your pillow.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY You knew him the moment he came to the river door on the 22nd: Kit Kessler, the Keeper. He asked for the Merrimack Room, and a rye at nine o'clock.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY His order for tonight: rye, one finger, a spoon of honey, nine o'clock sharp, in the Merrimack Room. You were to bring it.

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You alone sell the House's tincture. One bottle, one sale a night, and only against a numbered marker handed to you by its owner at the bar.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Every marker carries the number of its owner on the Keeper's List. Markers 18 to 22 never came back to the House.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to hand the House's keys to its new master.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem: You once filed a Montreal telegram, paid in advance, with no sender.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Erika Lamm: You bought a name at the river steps for $20 and were told at least twenty others did too.

You start with **$1,200** *in House bills (12 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the vault cloche. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A glass dome over a marble stand hides what the House keeps under glass.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **What Sheriff Theodor Farrago is hiding**

Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Sheriff Theodor Farrago's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point.

Type: *The key word or name* **1 POINT**

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THE BLACK VEIL
Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Rhea Mallya of Mallya's Emporium

Department store owner

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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TONIGHT

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Everything under one roof, from hats to hatboxes, under a sign that says the customer is always right. The prices say otherwise.

BACKGROUND

Mallya's Emporium has three floors, a druggist's counter, and a standing account with half this room. You know what everyone buys, which is more than most of them know about themselves.

- Tim McGinley: you stock his gin in the back room under the label of a tonic.
- Anika Mahns: an unpaid account the size of a small house.
- Silas Palmer: dresses his band at your counter.

WHAT TO WEAR The newest silk you stock, a mask in a matching shade, and an air of closing a sale.

THE BLACK VEIL

Rhea Mallya of Mallya's Emporium · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You sold the House its last bottle of nux vomica and rang it up as “river rats” without asking how many.

WHAT YOU KNOW

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Your emporium's druggist sold the House the last bottle of nux vomica in September. The signature on the poison book: R. Chow.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Anthony Hung, Esq.: You drew name-change papers for a dozen strangers, paid in gold by “a friend,” and kept the carbon.

You start with **$1,500** *in House bills (15 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the decoy duck. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A decoy that is hollow inside sits in the cabinet. Lift its head.

Type: *The code on the tag*

1 POINT

OBJECTIVE 2 **Who were you?**

You have worn this cover for a year. Learn what you really were before you took this name: some guests have noticed what a cover cannot hide.

Type: *What was your real trade?*

1 POINT

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Sheriff Theodor Farrago

Sheriff

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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LAST CALL

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YOUR PUBLIC FACE

A tin star, a quiet office and a long memory. Knows everyone's business and writes down very little.

BACKGROUND

You have held the star for six years and your county has never been quiet. A feud with Leon Gee, who mocks your department on the radio every night, has become the best entertainment in the county.

- Leon Gee: you would happily arrest him for being insufferable on the radio, and he knows what that is worth.
- Emmerich Sunner: the county physician reports to you and examines every body you find.
- Tiffany Liu: the windows of your office are hers, and so, you suspect, is some of the gossip about you.

WHAT TO WEAR A black cowboy hat, a tin star, handcuffs on your belt, and a stern face for the photographs.

THE BLACK VEIL

Sheriff Theodor Farrago · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You keep a shoebox with seventeen “accidents” in it and have told no one.

WHAT YOU KNOW

YOURS TO SHARE Between December 1924 and September 1925 seventeen people with no records and no families died in “accidents” in your county: a fire, a fall, a drowning, an aeroplane. You never found a link.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR You hold the Coroner's Folder, sealed until the body is found. Inside is the physician's printed report.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY You counted seventeen “accidents.” A clerk's note you found says “twenty-two to be placed.” Five are unaccounted for.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to swear a man in. It did not say who.

YOURS TO SHARE His register of every gun he has sold has never once been shown to you for a licence check, and he can name any customer's face after one look.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY On 15 September 1925 a man named Ignatius Bell was shot in a “brawl” at a Granite Street shed. Nobody claimed his body.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Three of your 1925 “accidents” were runners who carried messages for the Veil; the last drowned in the river and the coroner said accident. The girl who ran with them was never found.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Arjun Bat: You hauled bricks in 1921 for a wall in the Merrimack Room that is too thick.

YOUR HABIT You check the exits of every room you enter, a lawman's habit. Let people see you do it.

You start with **$1,000** *in House bills (10 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the Eighteenth Amendment. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A little green book of the nation's laws, the one that made the Veil necessary.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **The Leon matter**

You hold a Nuisance Citation against Leon Gee for being insufferable. Take a bribe from a go-between and tear the citation up: the go-between hands you a Pardon slip. Type the code on the slip.

Type: *The code on the Pardon slip* **1 POINT**

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THE BLACK VEIL

Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Sidd Airwind

Barnstormer

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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LAST CALL

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YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Flies from town to town in a patched-up plane, selling rides and thrills to anyone with a dollar. Has seen every field in New England from above, and doesn't much like the ground.

BACKGROUND

You barnstorm the county's fairs and carry mail when the roads are mud. You are always the first to ask which way the door is, and the last to say why.

- Krrish Vermouth: ships you the vermouth you pour over the fairgrounds on a good day.
- Tiffany Liu: sold you a lamp for your hangar, and a story for it.
- Leon Gee: reads your weather on the air, wrongly.

WHAT TO WEAR A flying jacket and leather helmet, goggles pushed up on your forehead, a wristwatch you glance at constantly, and a white silk scarf.

THE BLACK VEIL

Sidd Airwind · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You trained a mechanic who was later paid to be careless once.

WHAT YOU KNOW

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY Last winter you flew a woman with a stiff shoulder and a veil to a field outside Boston, no questions asked. She paid in gold and signed the logbook with a plain C.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Your black envelope was on House stock, signed only “The House.” The man who used to write the House's notes had a stiff hand, and so did this one.

YOURS TO SHARE Dr. Sunner dots his i's with a tiny ring, as you saw on the prescription for your airsickness. Every prescription clerk in the county was taught to, and his diploma is genuine.

YOURS TO SHARE Erika has sat facing the door of every hangar you ever hid her in. It is a fugitive's habit, and everybody knows it.

YOURS TO SHARE At the aerodrome the Sheriff checks every exit before he will stand beside a plane. A lawman's habit.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY A flier who barnstormed the Granite Street fairground that fall heard that Ignatius Bell, who held the second door at the Veil, was shot in the shed behind it, and that the big man who worked the other door was never found.

YOURS TO SHARE She read your logbook upside down across the table and corrected your arithmetic. A courier learns to read anything from any side.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor: You wear your father's brass key on a ribbon under your collar and have never once tried it in a lock.

YOUR HABIT You glance at your wristwatch every time a door opens, a flier's habit. Do it whenever someone comes or goes.

You start with **$1,400** *in House bills (14 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **Money to make**

Sell rides in your plane to anyone with a dollar. Leave with at least $2,000. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A thing to find**

Find the route globe. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. The whole world turns on a stand by the window, with the hours marked round its rim.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

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THE BLACK VEIL
Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Silas Palmer of the Palm Court

Jazz scat singer

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

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LAST CALL

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YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Sings the words nobody wrote, ba-doo-be-da and all, and leads the band that keeps the floor moving.

BACKGROUND

You lead the band at the Palm Court and sing the scat that carries over any room. The papers like you; the booking agents like you more, because you never ask to be paid in anything but cash.

- Leon Gee: broadcasts your records on WFEA, and says the scat reminds him of someone.
- Anika Mahns: a patron of the band, and not one who explains herself.
- Luke Shelldon: books your orchestra for the carnival.

WHAT TO WEAR White tie and tails, a long cigarette holder, a hat you tip to everyone, and a mask in black lace.

THE BLACK VEIL

Silas Palmer of the Palm Court · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You have sung the same scat phrase at every club since 1921, and it was Cassie's own call.

WHAT YOU KNOW

YOURS TO SHARE Before every set in 1924 the Keeper sent the band a note: nothing louder than a whisper at nine o'clock, when he took his rye with honey.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to play the Veil's old fanfare. Nobody has played it since 1924.

YOURS TO SHARE “The veil lifts” was Cassie's own toast to the band every closing night. You would know it anywhere, even in a stranger's hand on an unsigned card.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY At your table he copied a signature onto a napkin so exactly that you could not tell it from the original, then burned it, laughing. A hand like that is a trade, not a hobby.

YOURS TO SHARE She priced your tails to the penny from across the room and told you where your tailor had cut a corner.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY The girls who sewed the band's costumes were killed one by one that winter. You asked the costume mistress to dress the band again; she had vanished.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Leon Gee of WFEA: You once read the Sheriff's private mail aloud on the air by mistake, and he has never forgiven it.

YOUR HABIT You tip your hat to everyone you pass and set it straight by the brim afterward, a bandleader's courtesy. Do it at every greeting.

You start with **$1,200** *in House bills (12 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **Money to make**

Sing for your supper, and pass the hat. Leave with at least $1,800. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A thing to find**

Find the opera bill. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A fat knight with his cup hangs in the hall. The tag is at the corner of the frame.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

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THE BLACK VEIL
Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Tiffany Liu of the Lamps

Stained-glass artist

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

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FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

Turns broken glass into lamps and windows people stop and stare at. Everything made here glows a little like a secret.

BACKGROUND

You have your own glass studio and a loupe you never leave behind. Your lamps hang in the Sheriff's office and your windows hang in the churches, and you have cut a brass plate or two for the Veil itself.

- Leon Gee: a neighbour in the glass, who reads the Sheriff's mail aloud and your lamps' prices with equal pleasure.
- Joshua Kamin-Sky: reads the glass you make.
- Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff's office windows are yours.

WHAT TO WEAR A glassworker's apron, a loupe on a ribbon, and a mask of stained-glass shards.

THE BLACK VEIL

Tiffany Liu of the Lamps · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You cut the brass plate “KEEPER · K.K.” and your chisel slipped on the second K.

WHAT YOU KNOW

YOURS TO SHARE You cut the brass plate on the Veil's register: “KEEPER · K.K.” You know whose initials those are: Kit Kessler's.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to engrave a seal. It did not say for whom.

YOURS TO SHARE Every handbill the barker paints has a tiny ring over each i, and when he signs for a delivery he taps his pen twice afterward, as if sealing it.

YOURS TO SHARE She asked who cut your apron, and named the maker and the dye lot at a glance.

YOURS TO SHARE He moved his chair twice tonight, until he could see the door.

YOURS TO SHARE The Sheriff counts the windows and the doors of every room before he sits. You hung his office windows; he checked them for exits first.

YOURS TO SHARE Sidd checks his wristwatch every time a door opens. A flier counts minutes by habit and has done since the war.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About J. Bruce Wayne: Your “office” is the back room of a hat shop, and the Keeper once used its telephone to call Boston.

You start with **$1,000** *in House bills (10 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **A thing to find**

Find the glowing bottle. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. A bottle of wine that glows in the dark, though nobody lit it.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A fair trade**

Strike a bargain with Joshua Kamin-Sky: your glass earring for their soothsayer's charm. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag.

Type: *The code on the tag you received* **1 POINT**

Objectives 3 to 5 are in your black envelope

If you are one of the five, your private page already knows. Everyone else's has the same sealed flap with nothing behind it.

Type your answers on your phone whenever you like. Only your last answer counts.

THE BLACK VEIL
Manchester, N.H. · All Hallows' Eve, 1926

Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin

Gin baron

WHAT THE TOWN KNOWS

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

The masquerade was the talk of Manchester, right up until the music stopped. The orchestra slipped in by the river door. Four masked guests slipped up to the private landing. By midnight the papers were screaming massacre, and nobody could find a body, a name, or a coroner willing to sign for one. The proprietress, Miss Cassie Castello, had vanished with the last dance.

TONIGHT

The black envelopes came to your door, signed by nobody you would dare name. You came anyway. Curious. A little reckless. Wear it well. Before the night is through, someone will be found dead, and the rest of you will have opinions.

FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

YOUR PUBLIC FACE

The finest gin in Manchester comes out of the biggest bathtub, delivered with a smile and no questions.

BACKGROUND

You are in your second year of going straight, which means your gin now has a license plate. You ran the launch at the foot of the river steps in 1924 and have been trying to forget what you saw.

- Rebecca Chow: the House's Butler; you supply the House, and what it does not know about your gin is little.
- Rhea Mallya: stocks your gin in the Emporium's back room under the label of a tonic.
- Anthony Hung: your lawyer; you do not pay him on time.

WHAT TO WEAR A gangster's pinstripe, a flask-shaped bulge, and a black half-mask with a gin-green ribbon.

THE BLACK VEIL

Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin · Private

PRIVATE

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD Two passengers went down the river steps that night; one came back alone with blood on his cuff.

WHAT YOU KNOW

NEVER SAY IT ALOUD You ran the launch at the foot of the river steps that night. Two passengers went down the stairs; one came back alone with blood on his cuff and told you to forget the second. You have not forgotten.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY You ran the launch the night of 31 October and saw a woman with a bandaged shoulder pull herself out of the water at the foot of the river steps, alive, while the Keeper's car drove away without her.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY At the druggist's in September you saw R. Chow of the House sign the poison book for four ounces of nux vomica tincture, “for river rats.”

YOURS TO SHARE The House keeps a bottle of “rat tincture” under the bar for the river rats. You have seen the Butler lock it away: one sale a night, markers only.

COSTS A BILL: PAY AT THE BAR Your invitation was on House stock, signed only “The House,” and posted from Boston. The House has not written to you since 1924, and you owe it a favour you have been dreading.

YOURS TO SHARE You have lost to Angelos at cards since 1919. The way he counts chips with his thumb is just the trade.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY The launch fare for the vault advance was paid out of “the Teller's share.” Later you learned that same share paid the hitman.

YOURS TO SHARE She once walked from the river steps to Elm Street in four minutes by streets that are not on any map. A courier's trick.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY That winter the Veil's runners died one at a time. The last was thrown into the river off the Granite Street steps, and the boatman who did it bragged that it was paid for out of the other runner's own share.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Dr. Emmerich Sunner: You ate beet sandwiches for a week to prove the “blood” was beets and sugar.

TRADE IT, DON'T GIVE IT AWAY About Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil: The House whiskey is cold tea, and you took $200 to forget Room 3.

You start with **$1,500** *in House bills (15 × $100)*

YOUR OBJECTIVES

OBJECTIVE 1 **Money to make**

A baron's business is the margin. Sell, trade and bargain. Leave with at least $2,100. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them.

Type: *Dollars in your pocket at the end* **1 POINT**

OBJECTIVE 2 **A thing to find**

Find the launch's fog horn. It is hidden in a shared room, never in anyone's belongings, and it carries a small black tag with a code. Something that once sounded a warning across the water now sits on the bookshelf.

Type: *The code on the tag* **1 POINT**

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